Aquifer Open Study Notes

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1 Chronicles

1 Chronicles 1:1–4

A summary of the generations from Adam to the sons of Noah (compare Genesis 5:3–32).

1 Chronicles 1:1–2.2

The Chronicler starts by showing Israel's place among the nations. He traces their ancestry from Adam to Jacob, using information from Genesis.

1 Chronicles 1:5–23

The record of Noah's descendants shows Abraham's place in history. The ethnic background of the seventy nations gives context to Israel's history (compare Genesis 10).

1 Chronicles 1:13

the father…of the Hittites: Hebrew ancestor of Heth.

1 Chronicles 1:24–27

The summary of Shem's descendants concludes with Abraham (see Genesis 11:10–26).

1 Chronicles 1:28–33

The Chronicler, like the author of Genesis, lists Abraham's descendants separately from Isaac. He mentions Ishmael's sons (1 Chronicles 1:29–31; compare Genesis 25:12–15) and Keturah's sons (1 Chronicles 1:32–33; compare Genesis 25:1–3) before focusing on the chosen family line.

1 Chronicles 1:34–2.2

Isaac's genealogy first lists Esau's descendants (1 Chronicles 1:35–54) and then continues with Israel. The history of Edom is divided into three parts:

- Esau's sons (1 Chronicles 1:35–37)
- Seir's descendants (1 Chronicles 1:38–42)
- The kings who ruled Edom (1 Chronicles 1:43–54)

This arrangement follows Genesis 36.

1 Chronicles 1:51–54

The Chronicler names the clan leaders of Edom based on the sources he had (see Genesis 36:40–43).

1 Chronicles 2:3

Er and Onan, the first two sons of Judah, faced destruction because of their sins (Genesis 38:6–10). The descendants of Shelah appear as an addition at the end of Judah's genealogies (1 Chronicles 4:21–23).

1 Chronicles 2:3–8

The genealogy of Judah is detailed, including background information on David's ancestors. Compare Genesis 46:12.

1 Chronicles 2:3–4.23

The genealogies show all the people of Israel (1 Chronicles 2:1–2), but they focus more on David's ancestors from the tribe of Judah.

1 Chronicles 2:4–5

- The main ancestral line of David comes from Perez, one of Tamar's sons. Tamar was Judah's widowed daughter-in-law.
- Hamul, one of Perez's sons, is not mentioned at all. The Chronicler might not have had information about him.

1 Chronicles 2:6–8

For the family history of Zerah, compare Joshua 7:1, 17; 1 Kings 4:31 (Mahol might be another name for Zerah).

1 Chronicles 2:7

devoted things: See "Complete Destruction" Theme Note.

1 Chronicles 2:9

Caleb was the most notable direct descendant of Hezron, so the author describes his descendants in detail (1 Chronicles 2:42–55). This Caleb was apparently different from Caleb, son of Jephunneh, who was a descendant of Kenaz (see study note on 1 Chronicles 4:13–15).

1 Chronicles 2:9–55

The descendants of Hezron are listed up to the time of David in several sections:

- The direct line from Hezron to David (1 Chronicles 2:9–17; compare Ruth 4:18–22)
- The other descendants of Hezron (1 Chronicles 2:18–41)
- The descendants of Hezron's son Caleb (1 Chronicles 2:42–55)

1 Chronicles 2:10–17

The passage about Ram's descendants shows a direct line from Ram to Jesse and then lists Jesse's children.

1 Chronicles 2:14–15

The Chronicler lists David as the seventh son of Jesse, while Samuel lists him as the eighth (1 Samuel 16:6–13; 17:12). Samuel does not mention the names of David's fourth, fifth, or sixth brothers:

- Nethanel
- Raddai
- Ozem

Later, the Chronicler mentions a brother named Elihu, who might have been an additional son (see study note on 1 Chronicles 27:18). The number seven, considered the "perfect" number, might symbolize that God chose David to rule.

1 Chronicles 2:20

The Lord selected Bezalel, a craftsman from Hezron's family, to build the Tabernacle (see Exodus 31:1–2).

1 Chronicles 2:21–23

Some families from Gilead, who are listed as part of the tribe of Manasseh (see Numbers 32:39–42), also had ties to the tribe of Judah.

1 Chronicles 2:24

Tekoa was a small village in Judea, located southeast of Bethlehem (see also 1 Chronicles 4:5–8).

1 Chronicles 3:1–9

The list of David's sons comes from information in the book of Samuel (2 Samuel 3:2–5; 5:14–16). The list separates the sons born while David ruled in Hebron from those born in Jerusalem.

1 Chronicles 3:1–24

The genealogy of David continues from the genealogy of Ram (1 Chronicles 2:10–17), listing David as the seventh son of Jesse (2:15). David's genealogy has three parts:

1. David's sons (1 Chronicles 3:1–9)
2. The kings of Judah up to Jehoiachin and Zedekiah (1 Chronicles 3:10–16), who were exiled to Babylon
3. The descendants of Jehoiachin up to the Chronicler's time (1 Chronicles 3:17–24)

1 Chronicles 3:10–16

The Chronicler lists the kings of Judah in order, from father to son, starting with Solomon and ending with the exile in Babylon.

1 Chronicles 3:15

Three of Josiah's four sons became kings of Judah.

1 Chronicles 3:16

The successors of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah his son, and Zedekiah: At the end of Judah's monarchy, the eldest son did not always become king.

1 Chronicles 3:17–23

This part of David's family tree goes up to about 400 BC.

1 Chronicles 3:21

The descendants of Hananiah…Shecaniah: In Hebrew, all names are listed as "the sons" of Hananiah, suggesting one generation. However, many ancient manuscripts and translations suggest the list spans several generations. They translate "sons of" (Hebrew beney) as "son of" (Hebrew beno). This genealogy then covers several generations from the time of Zerubbabel and his son Hananiah.

1 Chronicles 4:1–7

The genealogy of Judah continues, linking back to 1 Chronicles 2:1–55. It immediately connects to Hur, the ancestor of Bethlehem (1 Chronicles 4:1–4; see 2:19–20, 51–55).

1 Chronicles 4:9–10

The section about Jabez stands alone, allowing the Chronicler to explain his name's origin. Jabez is not mentioned earlier, although it is also the name of a town where some of Hur's son Salma's descendants lived (1 Chronicles 2:55). Jabez likely got his name because he caused his mother pain, fulfilling Eve's curse (Genesis 3:16). Despite his name being a curse, he was more honorable than his brothers, and his prayer changed his life's outcome. The prayer is poetic and includes a plea for blessing, along with requests for prosperity and protection from harm. His last request might mean "keep me from causing trouble and pain." God listened to his prayer and removed his curse.

1 Chronicles 4:9–20

The exact family trees of Judah's remaining descendants are unknown. The Chronicler likely had incomplete information.

1 Chronicles 4:13–15

The name Kenaz also appears as a descendant of Esau through Eliphaz (Genesis 36:11). Kenaz's descendants

are known as the Kenizzites. The Kenizzites lived in the southern part of the land and had ties with Judah and Edom. Caleb, son of Jephunneh, was a Kenizzite (Numbers 32:12; Joshua 14:6) and had a brother named Kenaz (Joshua 15:17), whose family is listed here.

1 Chronicles 4:18

Mered's wife, Bithia, was a daughter of Pharaoh. This made some of Judah's descendants part Egyptian.

1 Chronicles 4:21–23

After recording Judah's descendants through his wife Tamar (1 Chronicles 2:4–4:20), the text lists the descendants of Shelah, Judah's third son with Bathshua (see 1 Chronicles 2:3; Genesis 38:2, 5).

1 Chronicles 4:24–43

Simeon was Jacob's second son. His tribe's land was in southern Judah (Joshua 19:1–9).

1 Chronicles 4:24–8.40

After finishing the genealogy of Judah's descendants (1 Chronicles 2:3–4:23), the Chronicler examines the records for the other sons of Israel (compare 2:1–2).

1 Chronicles 4:34–43

The list of men described as leaders of Simeon's wealthy clans (1 Chronicles 4:34–38) leads into the description of Simeon's geographic expansion (4:38–43). The tribe expanded with thirteen family leaders during Hezekiah's time (late 700s BC) in the Gerar area. This might have been part of Hezekiah's military action against Philistine territories (2 Kings 18:8).

1 Chronicles 4:39

Gedor: The exact location is unclear because Gedor (in Hebrew) is a common name. The Greek version, Gerar, likely refers to a city in Philistia, west of Judah (Genesis 10:19).

1 Chronicles 4:41

devoting them to destruction: See "Complete Destruction" Theme Note.

1 Chronicles 5:1–2

Reuben was Israel's oldest son, but he lost his birthright because he had sexual relations with his father's concubine (Genesis 35:22). Jacob gave this right to Joseph by making Ephraim and Manasseh full members of the tribes (Genesis 48:5). This act gave Joseph the double portion usually meant for the firstborn (Deuteronomy 21:15–17). As Jacob predicted, Judah became more prominent than his brothers and was the ancestor of the ruling tribe (Genesis 49:8–10). However, Reuben is still listed first (1 Chronicles 2:1).

1 Chronicles 5:1–24

Chapter 5 lists the family histories for:

- Reuben (1 Chronicles 5:1–10; compare Genesis 46:9)
- Gad (1 Chronicles 5:11–17)
- Manasseh (1 Chronicles 5:23–24)

These are the tribes of Israel that settled in Transjordan (the area east of the Jordan River).

1 Chronicles 5:3

The sons of Reuben are also mentioned in Genesis 46:9; Exodus 6:14; Numbers 26:5–6.

1 Chronicles 5:4–8

We do not know how Joel's descendants are related to the rest of the Reuben tribe.

1 Chronicles 5:6

Tiglath-pileser was the king of Assyria from 744 to 727 BC. He attacked the tribes of Transjordan during King Pekah's reign, which lasted from 752 to 732 BC. He took the people into captivity (see 1 Chronicles 5:25–26; 2 Kings 15:29).

1 Chronicles 5:10

The tribes of Transjordan, including the Reubenites, expanded their settlements north and east during their war with the Hagrites in Saul's time (see 1 Chronicles 5:18–22; Psalm 83:6). Later, some Hagrites joined David's men (see 1 Chronicles 11:38; 27:31).

1 Chronicles 5:18–22

The story of the war against the Hagrites expands on the elements introduced in 1 Chronicles 5:10. It was a conflict among shepherds over grazing land. All three tribes took part. The Chronicler describes their skills, military abilities, and numbers. With God fighting against the enemy, they won a great victory, gaining huge spoils and complete control of the territory.

1 Chronicles 5:25–26

The tribes of Reuben, Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh went into permanent exile due to their unfaithfulness.

1 Chronicles 6:1

The three sons of Levi are mentioned, but their family trees are given after the list of high priests.

1 Chronicles 6:1–48

This section gives the family histories of the three main groups of the tribe of Levi:

1. The high priests (1 Chronicles 6:1–15)
2. The three clans of Levites (1 Chronicles 6:16–30)
3. The singers (1 Chronicles 6:31–47)

Each family history starts with an introduction and then lists the names.

1 Chronicles 6:1–81

This section highlights the importance of the priestly tribe of Levi due to its central position in the genealogical lists.

1 Chronicles 6:2–15

After the exile in Babylon, the Judean community needed to confirm the legitimate ancestry of the priests. This genealogy of Kohath linked the ancestors from the Pentateuch to the high priests up to Judah's exile in 586 BC. Other records connected the priests after the exile to this lineage (see Ezra 3:2; 7:1–6; Haggai 1:1). Not all high priests were included in this list.

1 Chronicles 6:10

Most Old Testament scholars agree that the phrase about the high priest at the Temple built by Solomon in Jerusalem should be in 1 Chronicles 6:9 (related to the first Azariah). They believe a scribal error changed the order. Correcting this shows 12 generations between Aaron and the Temple's construction, matching the date in 1 Kings 6:1 (480 years equals 12 generations of 40 years each in numerical typology). The correction also shows 12 generations between the Temple's construction under Azariah and its rebuilding under Jeshua (Ezra 3:2).

1 Chronicles 6:16–30

The second introduction of the Levites (1 Chronicles 6:16–19a) presents the leaders of all the Levitical families (6:19b–30). The list includes the family trees of:

- Gershon (1 Chronicles 6:20–21)
- Kohath (1 Chronicles 6:22–24)
- Merari (1 Chronicles 6:29–30)

1 Chronicles 6:27

When Samuel worked for Eli, he took on a role similar to a Levite (1 Samuel 3:1).

1 Chronicles 6:31–47

This genealogy lists the lead singers from Kohath (1 Chronicles 6:33), Gershon (6:39), and Merari (6:44), the main Levitical families.

1 Chronicles 6:33

Heman was the lead singer among David's musicians (see Psalm 88:1).

1 Chronicles 6:39

Asaph wrote several psalms (Psalms 50; 73–83).

1 Chronicles 6:49

This explanation of the priests' rights introduces the following list.

1 Chronicles 6:50–53

The list of priests from Aaron to Ahimaaz introduces the territorial list (1 Chronicles 6:54–81). The list continues to the time of David, when Ahimaaz served (2 Samuel 15:36; 17:17–29; 18:19–29).

1 Chronicles 6:54–81

The list of Levitical cities comes from Joshua 21. It follows a geographical order, with families grouped by specific areas. This list shows Israel's unity and completeness. It presents the Levites as settled in the land just like the other tribes.

1 Chronicles 7:1–40

- This chapter provides the genealogies of the remaining tribes of Israel.
- The sections on the tribes of Issachar, Benjamin, and Asher may come from a military census. These lists are almost the same length, use military terms, record the father's houses, and do not mention settlements.
- The tribes of Zebulun and Dan are completely omitted, and Naphtali has only a short record.

1 Chronicles 7:12

The Hebrew text of this verse seems disrupted, likely due to a loss during scribal copying, as there is no introduction for Ir or Hushim. The names Shuppim and Huppim appear in the tribe of Benjamin (1 Chronicles 8:8, 11; Genesis 46:21; Numbers 26:39). If the Hebrew

text is indeed damaged, Hushim might be a descendant of Dan (compare Genesis 46:23; Numbers 26:42).

1 Chronicles 7:13

Unlike other genealogies, this list of Naphtali's sons shows only the first generation (see Genesis 46:24; Numbers 26:48–50). The Chronicles manuscript might have been damaged early in its copying, which could explain why Dan and Zebulun are missing. It is also possible that records for Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali were lost when Tiglath-pileser attacked and exiled these tribes during Pekah's reign (2 Kings 15:29). In that case, the Chronicler had no records to include.

1 Chronicles 7:14–19

These verses have several issues that suggest the Hebrew text might be damaged:

1. Maacah is listed as both the sister and wife of Makir (1 Chronicles 7:15–16).
2. Huppim and Shuppim were earlier listed with Benjamin (1 Chronicles 7:12), not Manasseh.
3. Those considered Gileadites (1 Chronicles 7:16–17) are vaguely linked to Gilead, whose direct descendants are not listed (compare Numbers 26:30–33).
4. The sons of Shemida are not connected to the genealogy (1 Chronicles 7:19) Shemida was one of Gilead's descendants (Numbers 26:32).

1 Chronicles 7:20–27

The genealogy of Ephraim's descendants includes a story about how the tribe settled in Canaan (1 Chronicles 7:21–24). The genealogy concludes with Joshua, son of Nun, who led Israel into the promised land.

1 Chronicles 7:22

Ephraim is recorded as the father of Ezer and Elead. However, Ephraim, the son of Joseph, could not have settled in Canaan after the Exodus. Traditionally, people imagined an early exodus for Ephraim's family. Other possibilities include that the name Ephraim is a scribal error or that Ephraim referred to the tribe, not Joseph's son.

1 Chronicles 8:1–40

The genealogy of Benjamin's descendants concludes the genealogies. The record starts with Judah, David's tribe, and ends with Benjamin, Saul's tribe.

1 Chronicles 8:3

Gera, Abihud: According to the translation, Bela had two sons named Gera (1 Chronicles 8:3, 5), which is unusual. If the suggestion in the New Living Translation note is correct, the second Gera was the son of the first Gera.

1 Chronicles 8:6–28

This list shows the militia from the clans of Ehud (1 Chronicles 8:6–7) and Shaharaim (8:8–28). They lived near Jerusalem.

1 Chronicles 8:7

The reason for this exile is unknown. It might have been a voluntary move from the territory of Benjamin, possibly during the time of the judges.

1 Chronicles 8:29–32

This list shows the militia that lived in Gibeon, although some had moved to Jerusalem.

1 Chronicles 8:33–40

The Chronicler ends his account of Benjamin's history with Saul's family tree. It starts two generations before Saul and goes through Merib-baal (also known as Mephibosheth; see study note on 2 Samuel 4:4) and continues to the families of Azel and Eshek (1 Chronicles 8:38–40). Micah (1 Chronicles 8:35) lived during Solomon's time, and Ulam (8:39) lived near the end of Judah's kingdom before Jerusalem's destruction. This connects Saul to his broader tribal history and a noble heritage that lasted throughout the kingdom period.

1 Chronicles 9:1

- The statement that all Israel was listed in the genealogical records highlights the Chronicler's main idea. It shows that all Israel was represented by the Judean community during the Chronicler's time, maintaining a connection with Israel's past.
- The Book of the Kings of Israel was a source document used by the authors of both Kings and Chronicles, but it is now lost (see also study note on 1 Kings 14:19–20).
- The people of Judah were exiled due to unfaithfulness, just like the other tribes (1 Chronicles 5:25–26; 6:15; see 2 Chronicles 36:20–21).

1 Chronicles 9:1–34

The Chronicler explains how people and institutions returning from the exile in Babylon connected with the past. The Levites and priests are important in this summary of Israel. The Chronicler believes they were central to the nation's organization. They were vital to Israel's success as a nation with God as king. The Chronicler used ancient records from Moses and

David (1 Chronicles 9:19–22) to describe each group's homeland and rank.

1 Chronicles 9:3–9

lived in Jerusalem: Jerusalem was always central to Israel. People from all tribes lived there, both before and after the exile in Babylon. This statement confirms that some members of the northern tribes returned from exile.

1 Chronicles 9:21

Tent of Meeting: See study note on Exodus 27:21.

1 Chronicles 9:28–32

the articles used in worship: See Exodus 25:8–30:38.

1 Chronicles 9:30

The priests mixed the spices for use in the tabernacle and temple. This blend was not for everyday use (Exodus 30:34–38).

1 Chronicles 9:32

the rows of the showbread every Sabbath: See Exodus 25:23–30.

1 Chronicles 9:34

- The mention of Jerusalem reminds readers of the start (1 Chronicles 9:3) and describes all of Israel by its leaders in that city.
- In explaining the duties of the priests and Levites, the Chronicler mainly focused on the leaders of Levite families (1 Chronicles 9:10–33).

1 Chronicles 9:35–44

Saul's family's role in the kingdom is already set (1 Chronicles 8:29–40). Repeating this information helps move from the genealogies to the stories, starting with Saul's death (1 Chronicles 10).

1 Chronicles 10:1–14

The story of Israel as a kingdom starts with Saul's death. Saul did not achieve God's plans for him as king or for Israel as a nation. His death made way for David, whom the Chronicler saw as Israel's first true king.

1 Chronicles 10:6–12

Saul died together with his three sons and all his house: The Chronicler does not mention Saul's armor bearer or the rest of his troops (see 1 Samuel 31:6). This emphasizes God's role in removing Saul and replacing him with David (1 Chronicles 10:14).

1 Chronicles 11:1–3

David first became king of Judah in Hebron and ruled there for seven and a half years (1 Chronicles 3:4; 2 Samuel 5:5). The Chronicler does not include the details of that time (see 2 Samuel 2–4) and instead focuses on David's 33 and a half years ruling the entire nation. This began with his agreement with all the elders of Israel at Hebron (see 2 Samuel 5:1–5).

1 Chronicles 11:4–9

David conquered and rebuilt Jerusalem, making it the capital city of his rule over all of Israel.

1 Chronicles 11:10

As the Lord promised, God chose David to be king, not David or the people (compare 1 Chronicles 11:3; 1 Samuel 16:11–14).

1 Chronicles 11:10–47

This story about David's mighty warriors shows that Israel's best and bravest men supported him, along with all of Israel (compare 2 Samuel 23:8–39).

1 Chronicles 11:41–47

Zabad…Jaasiel: These warriors, not mentioned in 2 Samuel 23, came from places east of the Jordan River. David had strong support from all the tribes of Israel and from foreigners.

1 Chronicles 12:1–22

Support for making David king started before Saul's death. When Saul was king and David was on the run, warriors joined David, forming a large group from various tribes across Israel. Even Saul's relatives left him to support David as king (1 Chronicles 12:2). David wisely assessed these deserters (1 Chronicles 12:17) to ensure they were not spies for Saul. Before David was officially anointed at Hebron, the people's wishes aligned with God's will for David to become king.

1 Chronicles 12:23–40

The succession of a king was often a contentious issue, especially when the new king came from a different family. The gathering of all twelve tribes at Hebron, including some of Saul's relatives (1 Chronicles 12:29), to confirm David's rule showed that the tribes had resolved their conflicts after Saul's death (12:23–37). The Chronicler emphasizes the unity among the tribes by stating that they all had the single purpose of making David the king over all Israel (1 Chronicles 12:38).

1 Chronicles 13:1–17.27

These chapters describe how Jerusalem became the political and religious center of Israel. The story begins with David's failed attempt to move the Ark of God from Kiriath-jearim to Jerusalem (1 Chronicles 13:1–14; compare 2 Samuel 6:2–11).

1 Chronicles 13:9–11

When Uzzah died, Israel's celebration quickly turned to sorrow. Touching the ark led to death because it violated its holiness (see 1 Chronicles 15:13).

1 Chronicles 13:12

David's reaction to Uzzah's death might show he felt unfit to move the ark to Jerusalem.

1 Chronicles 14:1–2

Hiram's generosity showed more proof of God's plan to make David king.

1 Chronicles 14:1–7

Although the ark was not in Jerusalem (1 Chronicles 13:1–14), God blessed David's palace, his children, and his victory over the Philistines. God's blessing did not rely on the ark's presence. These blessings eventually motivated David to follow through with his original plan to bring the ark into Jerusalem (1 Chronicles 15:1–29).

1 Chronicles 14:8–17

When David became ruler of all Israel, the Philistines attacked. They no longer saw him as under their control, as they did when he only ruled Judah. They attacked through the valley southwest of Jerusalem (see Joshua 15:8). Before the battle, David asked the Lord for guidance, unlike Saul, who asked a medium for help against the Philistines (1 Chronicles 10:13; see 1 Samuel 28).

1 Chronicles 14:12

David's orders to burn the Philistine idols followed God's instructions (Deuteronomy 7:5).

1 Chronicles 15:1–3

The first attempt to bring the ark to Jerusalem (1 Chronicles 13:1–14) failed due to improper procedure (see 15:13). This time, David prepared a place for the ark in Jerusalem and organized the Levites to carry it, as this was their responsibility (Deuteronomy 10:8; 18:5). The special tent David prepared for the ark was not the tabernacle, which was located at Gibeon at that time (see 1 Chronicles 16:39; 21:29).

1 Chronicles 15:1–29

David once more planned to bring the ark of God to Jerusalem. This time, he prepared carefully to ensure success.

1 Chronicles 15:13

See 1 Chronicles 13:1–10.

1 Chronicles 15:16–18

This is the first of three lists of Levitical musicians (see 1 Chronicles 15:19–22; 16:4–6). This list provides the names of the three leaders (Heman, Asaph, and Ethan; see 1 Chronicles 6:33–47) along with their assistants.

1 Chronicles 15:19–22

The second list of Levitical musicians highlighted their musical skills instead of their rank.

1 Chronicles 15:20

harps according to Alamoth: Alamoth is likely a melody sung in a soprano range. The word may be related to the Hebrew word 'almah,' which means "young woman."

1 Chronicles 15:21

lyres according to the Sheminith: Sheminith might relate to a term meaning "octave," suggesting a lower vocal range.

1 Chronicles 15:29

Michal's contempt for David (compare 2 Samuel 6:16–23) contrasts with God's blessing on the celebration (1 Chronicles 15:26). Her description as Saul's daughter suggests her attitude reflected her father's disregard for the Lord (see 1 Samuel 10:10–12; 13:7–14; 15:10–23; 28:1–25).

1 Chronicles 16:1–43

The transfer of the ark (1 Chronicles 16:1–3) and the event's conclusion (16:43) are reported just like in Samuel (see 2 Samuel 6:17–20). However, between these parts, the Chronicler adds details about the celebrations and the permanent worship arrangements (1 Chronicles 16:4–42). David's psalm of celebration is the main focus of the account.

1 Chronicles 16:7–36

David's song of thanksgiving combines three psalms:

- First Chronicles 16:8–22 uses Psalm 105:1–15
- First Chronicles 16:23–33 uses Psalm 96
- First Chronicles 16:34–38 uses Psalm 106:1, 47–48

The composer adjusted the sources for this occasion. The Temple did not exist when the ark was brought to Jerusalem, so the Chronicler says strength and joy fill his dwelling (1 Chronicles 16:27) instead of His sanctuary (Psalm 96:6) and asks the worshiper to come into his presence (1 Chronicles 16:29) instead of enter His courts (Psalm 96:8). The name Abraham (Psalm 105:9) changes to Israel (1 Chronicles 16:13) to focus on the nation as the fulfillment of Abraham's promises. The hymn does not mention the judgment of the earth (Psalm 96:10, 13; compare 1 Chronicles 16:30, 33) because it was not relevant to the ark's dedication.

1 Chronicles 16:39

Gibeon was the main place of worship until they built the temple in Jerusalem (see 1 Chronicles 21:29; 2 Chronicles 1:3). They had to reorganize the tabernacle staff because some Levites moved permanently to Jerusalem.

1 Chronicles 17:1–15

David wanted to build a home for the ark as grand as his palace, but the Lord chose David's heir, Solomon (1 Chronicles 22), to build the temple. Jerusalem was to be the only place of worship for all Israel.

1 Chronicles 17:1–27

The larger section (1 Chronicles 13:1–17:27) ends with Nathan's prophecy about David and David's prayer of thanks.

1 Chronicles 17:10–14

David wanted to build a temple for the Lord. Instead, the Lord promised to build a dynasty for David. Creating David's eternal dynasty was key to God's plan to establish his rule on earth.

1 Chronicles 17:12

Building the temple was a key part of God's kingdom on earth. Solomon built the temple (2 Chronicles 2–7) and fulfilled this promise.

1 Chronicles 17:13

The Chronicler specifically made this statement about Solomon (see 1 Chronicles 22:9; 28:5–6; compare 2 Samuel 7:14).

1 Chronicles 17:14

In 2 Samuel 7:16, God promises to establish David's house, kingdom, and throne. Here, the promise is for Solomon. The books of Samuel and Kings portray David as Israel's ideal king, but the Chronicler sees Solomon as David's equal. David prepared for building the temple, but God chose Solomon to build it. The promise to Israel was fulfilled during the reigns of both David and Solomon.

1 Chronicles 18:1

The Philistines were a constant threat to David's kingdom (see study notes on Joshua 13:2; 19:43; Judges 3:3). They stayed in their coastal settlements. Although David conquered Gath and its nearby towns, a Philistine king still ruled in Gath at the end of David's reign (1 Kings 2:39).

1 Chronicles 18:1–17

These war records describe how David expanded his kingdom by conquering:

- The Philistines (1 Chronicles 18:1)
- Moab (1 Chronicles 18:2)
- Zobah (1 Chronicles 18:3–4)
- Damascus (1 Chronicles 18:5–6)
- Edom (1 Chronicles 18:12–13)

They include details about David's international relations, the treasures he gained, and the tributes he received (1 Chronicles 18:7–11). A common theme is that the Lord gave David victory wherever he went (1 Chronicles 18:6, 13).

1 Chronicles 18:1–20.8

- This section tells about David's wars and military successes, showing him as a great warrior in Israel's history. It focuses on the public and political sides of David's enemies, with little about their private lives.
- There are three main parts that match accounts in Samuel:

1. Battles during the kingdom's expansion (1 Chronicles 18:1–17; see 2 Samuel 8:1–16)
2. The battle against the Ammonites (1 Chronicles 19:1–20:3; see 2 Samuel 10:1–11:1; 12:30–31)
3. The deeds of David's mighty men (1 Chronicles 20:4–8; see 2 Samuel 21:18–22)

Each part starts with a time transition (some time later) that loosely connects these events (1 Chronicles 18:1; 19:1; 20:4).

1 Chronicles 18:2–13

David conquered areas east of the Jordan River in stages. First, he took over Moab in the south, securing control of the plateau north of the Arnon River. His victory over the Aramean alliance led by Hadadezer resulted in an alliance with King Toi of Hamath, who was Hadadezer's enemy (1 Chronicles 18:9–11). After defeating Ammon and the Arameans east of the Jordan, David expanded his control over southern Edom and gained access to a southern seaport (1 Chronicles 18:12–13).

1 Chronicles 18:14–17

The list of David's officials shows the strength of his rule over all of Israel.

1 Chronicles 19:1–7

The new Ammonite ruler, Hanun, opposed Israel being near his nation. The Ammonites hired Aramean armies from the north. These combined forces gathered at Medeba to challenge David's control of Moab's plateau.

1 Chronicles 19:9–13

The enemy armies set up their battle lines carefully. The Ammonites positioned themselves so that the city of Medeba could be a safe place. Meanwhile, the Israelites faced a second attack from the Arameans. Joab split his forces to fight on both sides from a central gathering point.

1 Chronicles 19:13

- Joab understood that the battle aimed to protect the people and cities of Israel from invasion, not to gain more land (see 1 Chronicles 19:8).
- Joab trusted God, believing the outcome relied on the Lord's guidance.

1 Chronicles 19:16–19

In the battle against the Arameans, David achieved three goals:

1. He challenged Hadadezer's power
2. He disrupted the Aramean alliance
3. He stopped any future alliance between the Arameans and the Ammonites

1 Chronicles 20:1–3

This war against the Ammonites happened during David's sin with Bathsheba (2 Samuel 11:2–12:25), which the Chronicler does not mention.

1 Chronicles 21:1

Satan, (also called the adversary), encouraged David to count his military forces (see 2 Samuel 24:1). The Chronicler views the story in Samuel through his understanding of Satan as an opponent of God and humanity. God allows Satan to act in the world, and through this, Satan unknowingly serves God's purposes (see 2 Chronicles 18:3–34; Job 1:6–2:7; Zechariah 3:1–2; Matthew 4:1–11; John 13:27; 1 Corinthians 5:5; 2 Corinthians 12:7; 1 Timothy 1:20; Revelation 20:3, 7–9).

1 Chronicles 21:1–22.1

This account of the census is similar to 2 Samuel 24:1–25 but focuses on different aspects. The Chronicler's version sets the stage for dedicating the altar and preparing to build the temple (1 Chronicles 22).

1 Chronicles 21:7

The study note on 2 Samuel 24:1 explores why God was upset with the census.

1 Chronicles 21:9

Later, Gad is mentioned as having created a list of the acts of King David (1 Chronicles 29:29).

1 Chronicles 21:16–17

These verses describe the angel and David's response in more detail than the similar text in 2 Samuel 24:17. Seeing the angel on his mission moved David to plead for the people.

1 Chronicles 21:26–22.1

The census and plague led to dedicating Araunah's threshing floor as the site for the new sanctuary. Normally, offerings were made at Gibeon, where the tabernacle was located (see 1 Chronicles 16:39; 21:29; 2 Chronicles 1:3). The plague stopped at the threshing floor, allowing David to make offerings there as instructed by Gad the seer (1 Chronicles 21:18). David then chose this new location for the future temple of the Lord God.

1 Chronicles 22:2–19

God promised David that his kingdom would last forever and that his son would build a temple for the Lord (1 Chronicles 17:11–12). After choosing the site (1 Chronicles 21:18–22:1), David prepared to build the temple of God. He gathered materials (1 Chronicles 22:2–5) and instructed Solomon (22:6–16) and the leaders of Israel (22:17–19) to build the temple after his death.

1 Chronicles 22:5

When Solomon was young and inexperienced (see also 1 Chronicles 29:1; compare 1 Kings 3:7; 2 Chronicles 13:7), David used his wisdom and skill to prepare for building the temple. David also designed the temple (1 Chronicles 28:11–12). Later, God gave Solomon the wisdom he needed to build the temple and govern well (see 2 Chronicles 1:7–12).

1 Chronicles 22:8

God did not allow David to build the temple because he had shed much blood (see 1 Kings 5:3–4). David's wars were not wrong, and God had blessed and supported them. However, the bloodshed and deaths in battle made David ceremonially unclean (see 1 Chronicles 28:3; compare Genesis 4:10–12; Leviticus 17:3–4; Deuteronomy 21:1–9; Matthew 27:24–25). Therefore, he could not build a holy sanctuary for the Lord.

1 Chronicles 22:9–10

- Solomon was a man of peace, avoiding war and bloodshed in battle. The temple was constructed during his peaceful rule (see 2 Chronicles 2–7).
- The Hebrew text uses two different words to describe conditions during Solomon's reign:
- peace (Hebrew shalom, related to Solomon's name)
- quiet (Hebrew menukhah, related to the idea of redemption)

1 Chronicles 23:1–2

- When David appointed his son Solomon as Israel's king (see 1 Kings 1), he outlined the kingdom's organizational structure and made provisions for the temple's operation.
- The account of Solomon's coronation continues in 1 Chronicles 28–29; the chapters in between (23:3–27:24) detail the kingdom's organization.

1 Chronicles 23:3–5

The records of the Levites list them by their roles instead of their families.

1 Chronicles 23:6–23

David organized the Levites into groups based on their family lines. There were more clerics than needed for one temple. These groups allowed all priests and Levites to take turns serving in the temple (see Luke 1:5, 8).

1 Chronicles 23:24–27

In the census of 1 Chronicles 23:3, individuals were counted at age thirty. However, the registration of the divisions included those who were twenty years old or older (see Numbers 1:3). The age for starting Levitical service seemed to change over time based on need.

1 Chronicles 23:28–32

The Levites helped the priests in many ways. They maintained the temple, arranged the sacred bread and other offerings, sang, and assisted with sacrifices. Different family groups of Levites had specific duties (1 Chronicles 23:4–6).

1 Chronicles 24:1–2

The priests were organized into divisions for service, starting with Aaron's sons, Eleazar and Ithamar. All of Israel's priests came from these two men.

1 Chronicles 24:1–19

The information about the priests' duties only covers their organization into orders and how they assign responsibilities by casting lots. The Chronicler does not explain their duties because these were well established long ago (see Exodus 28:1–5; Leviticus 1–7; Numbers 6:22–27).

1 Chronicles 24:3–6

Zadok and Ahimelech led the two priestly families during King David's time (see 1 Chronicles 6:8; 18:16; 2 Samuel 8:17).

1 Chronicles 24:7–18

The twenty-four divisions for the priests stayed the same for many generations. The order of Abijah (1 Chronicles 24:10) is mentioned in Luke 1:5, 8.

1 Chronicles 24:20–31

The other family leaders might refer to tribe members who were not priests but had been documented (see 1 Chronicles 23:6–23), or it might refer to Levites not mentioned before. However, most families were already in the previous list. Therefore, this list seems to be a separate, additional list that complements the earlier register of Levites, possibly updating it at a later time.

1 Chronicles 24:31

The Levites were organized in the same way as the priests (1 Chronicles 24:5–6).

1 Chronicles 25:1

- Asaph: See 1 Chronicles 6:39–40; 15:17–19; 16:5; 2 Chronicles 29:30; Ezra 2:40–41; Psalms 50; 73–28.

- Heman: See 1 Chronicles 6:33–38; Psalm 88.
- Jeduthun: See 1 Chronicles 16:41–42; 2 Chronicles 5:12; 35:15; Psalms 39, 62, 77.

1 Chronicles 25:1–7

The musicians from King David's time are listed by their families: Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun.

1 Chronicles 25:2–3

Asaph and Jeduthun proclaimed God's messages, meaning they were prophets and musicians.

1 Chronicles 25:8

Like the priests, the families of musicians were chosen by sacred lots to ensure fairness (see 1 Chronicles 24:5, 31).

1 Chronicles 26:1

The first ancestor of the gatekeepers was Meshelemiah. He is called "Shallum" in Ezra 2:42 and "Meshullam" in Nehemiah 12:25.

1 Chronicles 26:5

God greatly blessed Obed-edom, who temporarily kept the ark (1 Chronicles 13:13–14), by giving him many descendants (26:8).

1 Chronicles 26:20–32

As Solomon prepared to become king, David appointed officials to organize the Levitical orders at the end of his reign. These officers included treasurers, administrators, and judges who were part of the government.

1 Chronicles 26:21–28

The Levites managed the Lord's treasuries and property (see 2 Chronicles 24:11; 31:12). People always dedicated some war spoils to God (1 Chronicles 26:26–28).

1 Chronicles 26:31

Jazer was a city for the Levites (Joshua 21:39) and later became an administrative center during the monarchy. David and his descendants relied on the loyalty of the Levites from Hebron (1 Samuel 30:27–31; 2 Samuel 2:1–11).

1 Chronicles 27:1–15

David organized his reserve army into twelve divisions. Each division served for one month each year. Their duties likely included protecting borders, policing, maintaining order in conquered areas, manning fortresses, and taking care of military equipment like horses and chariots. The divisions were not based on Israel's tribal structure. Each division included people from different tribes, showing the kingdom's integration.

1 Chronicles 27:16–22

The order of the tribes generally follows Numbers 1:5–15. It starts with Leah's six sons, then Rachel's two sons (Joseph's tribe is divided into Ephraim and Manasseh, followed by Benjamin), and then Bilhah's two sons (Dan and Naphtali). There are some changes:

- Naphtali is moved to his location next to Zebulun
- The tribe of Levi is added according to Levi's birth order, with Aaron's family (the priests) listed separately
- The list does not include Zilpah's two sons, Gad and Asher

1 Chronicles 27:18

The name Elihu might refer to Eliab (1 Chronicles 2:13), or he might have been another brother of David.

1 Chronicles 27:25–31

Ancient kings, like David, gathered a lot of property. This list details parts of David's estate, such as storehouses in Jerusalem and other areas, land for farming, and different kinds of livestock.

1 Chronicles 27:32–34

- The list of David's officials ends with influential people close to the king.
- A wise counselor to the king was likely a trusted advisor.

1 Chronicles 28:1

This gathering includes all the officials of Israel named in the earlier chapters.

1 Chronicles 28:1–29.25

The story of Solomon's coronation continues from 1 Chronicles 23:1–2. David, at the height of his power, transfers authority to Solomon (compare 1 Kings 1:1–2:9).

1 Chronicles 28:2

David described the temple as a place where the ark of the Lord's covenant could rest. The word "rest" signifies the conquest of the land and the establishment of peace (for example, Deuteronomy 12:9). In the wilderness, the ark rested after battles (Numbers 10:35–36).

When David brought the ark to Jerusalem, its "rest" became permanent. David expressed this in a psalm of worship: Arise, O LORD, to Your resting place, You and the ark of Your strength (Psalm 132:8). God chose Mount Zion as his resting place.

1 Chronicles 28:2–10

David's first speech includes a message to his people (1 Chronicles 28:2–8) and a message to Solomon (28:9–10). The main focus is David's wish for Solomon to build a temple. David also discusses two other important themes: God's choice of Solomon and the people's duty to follow God's commandments.

1 Chronicles 28:4–6

the LORD...chose me...to be king over Israel forever: God's selection of David started with Judah (Genesis 49:8–12), reached its peak with David (1 Samuel 16:1–13), and continued with Solomon (1 Chronicles 28:5–6, 10). All later kings ruled because of God's promise to David.

1 Chronicles 28:9–10

David's message to Solomon focused on the responsibilities of becoming king, not the privileges. Solomon's main duty was to seek, worship, and serve the Lord. The Lord also demanded a strong commitment to building the temple sanctuary.

1 Chronicles 28:11–21

God gave David the plans for the temple through divine inspiration (1 Chronicles 28:19). God also provided plans for the tabernacle in the wilderness (Exodus 25:9) and for Ezekiel's future temple (Ezekiel 40:4).

1 Chronicles 28:14–18

This list of vessels validated each item in the temple by detailing what God had told David about them.

1 Chronicles 28:18

for the chariot of the gold cherubim: The cherubim were images of creatures often found with thrones and palaces. Ancient kings sat on thrones with cherubim. In God's throne room, the most holy place of Israel's sanctuary, cherubim on top of the ark of the covenant served a similar role (see Exodus 25:18–22; 2 Samuel 6:2; Psalm 99:1; compare Ezekiel 10).

1 Chronicles 29:1–9

David convinced Israel's leaders (1 Chronicles 28:1) to give gifts to the Lord for the temple. David's generous gift set an example for the leaders. The Chronicler highlights that Solomon did not bear the heavy cost of building the temple alone. Solomon added to the contributions made by David and Israel's leaders (see 1 Chronicles 22:14).

1 Chronicles 29:6

Israel's leaders gave willingly, just like they did with the tabernacle (Exodus 25:1–7).

1 Chronicles 29:7

10,000 darics of gold: Persian darics were first minted during the reign of King Darius I of Persia, who ruled from 522 to 486 BC. When describing the temple gifts during Solomon's time, the Chronicler updated the information to match his era, similar to how the New Living Translation converts Hebrew weights and measures to modern equivalents.

1 Chronicles 29:10–19

David's prayer of praise ended his speeches at Solomon's coronation. The prayer praises God's power and the glory of his kingdom, and it dedicates the offerings for building the temple. The prayer has three parts:

1. The doxology (1 Chronicles 29:10b–13)
2. The presentation and dedication of the offerings (1 Chronicles 29:14–17)
3. The petition (1 Chronicles 29:18–19)

1 Chronicles 29:18–19

David did not ask God for power, victory, or riches, nor for Solomon's kingdom to be established. Instead, he asked God to help the people of Israel, especially Solomon, always want to obey the Lord. Having this kind of heart is a gift from the Lord; success and prosperity come second.

1 Chronicles 29:21–25

After the speeches and prayers at Solomon's coronation, sacrifices took place. Solomon and Zadok were anointed, and Solomon took the throne. Zadok was not starting his priestly role but was dedicated to serve in the temple itself. (The descendants of Zadok are mentioned in Ezekiel 40:46; 43:19; 44:15; 48:11.)

1 Chronicles 29:26–30

The Chronicler ends his account of David's reign with a formal summary, similar to those for all the kings of Israel and Judah (for example, 1 Kings 22:41–50). Like Abraham (Genesis 25:8) and Isaac (Genesis 35:29), David died at an old age with wealth and honor.

1 Chronicles 29:29

The chronicles of David's reign use sources linked to three prophets:

1. Samuel (1 Chronicles 11:3)
2. Nathan (1 Chronicles 17:1–27)
3. Gad (1 Chronicles 21:9)

The Chronicler also used other sources besides the books of Samuel and Kings (see study note on 1 Chronicles 9:1; see also 1 Kings 11:41–43; 14:19–20, 29–31).

1 Chronicles 29:30

The final verse praises David, highlighting him as the main figure of his era.